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UAE–Saudi ties built on shared history and common destiny

National Media Office chairman says responsible media must safeguard the relationship

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Sheikh Abdulla Bin Mohammed Bin Butti Al Hamed, Chairman of both the National Media Office and the UAE Media Council, has reaffirmed the strength of relations between the UAE and Saudi Arabia, saying they are rooted in a shared history and enduring fraternal bonds between two brotherly peoples united by a common destiny.

In a post on X, Sheikh Abdulla said the relationship continues to be strengthened by the wise leadership of both countries, whose close coordination and clear vision are advancing a future that serves the interests of their peoples and the wider region.

He added that responsible media has a duty to reflect this

reality objectively and confront any attempts to undermine or misrepresent it.

Brotherly relations

His remarks followed a post by Turki Al Sheikh, Chairman of Saudi Arabia's General Entertainment Authority, who shared a photograph of Prince Khalid Bin Salman, the Saudi Defence Minister, with Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court.

Al Sheikh wrote that Saudi Arabia and the UAE share "brotherly relations and a deeply-rooted partnership."

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, commented on the photograph, writing: "The biggest story in the Gulf is captured in a single photograph." He had earlier reposted the tweet with the verse: "Spears refuse to break when they stand together; but when they are separated, they break one by one, which means that unity is the foundation of strength, while division breeds weakness."



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

NEW INDIAN PASSPORT CENTRES OPEN FOR SERVICE

Hundreds of Indian nationals turned up early yesterday morning as the UAE's new network of Indian Consular Application Centres (ICACs) officially opened after weeks of uncertainty and legal challenges. This marks the biggest overhaul of Indian passport and consular services in the country in years. The services, now operated by Al Hind Tours & Travels, are available through 16 centres across the UAE, replacing in-person passport, visa, attestation and consular application services that were previously temporarily offered at the Indian Embassy in Abu Dhabi and the Consulate General of India in Dubai. **SEE ALSO P2**

IRANIAN MISSILES, DRONES INTERCEPTED BY BAHRAIN

Sirens also sounded in Saudi Arabia, Jordan

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The Bahrain Defence Force announced that its air defence systems yesterday successfully intercepted and destroyed several treacherous Iranian aerial attacks.

In a statement reported by the Bahrain News Agency, The General Command of the Bahrain Defence Force (BDF) said that Iran continues its systematic hostile approach through its unlawful attacks targeting civilians in Bahrain.

It stressed that the deliberate use of missiles and drones to target civilians and private property constitutes a flagrant violation of international humanitarian law.

Alert in Dammam

Saudi Arabia's National Platform for Early Warning in Emergency Situations issued an alert for the eastern city of Dammam yesterday, warning residents of a potential danger. The warning was announced by the Saudi Civil Defence on X. The alert was lifted around 10 minutes later.

Missile alert in Aqaba

Missile alert sirens sounded in Jordan's port city of Aqaba as officials in neighbouring Israel said an Iranian missile attack targeted the kingdom.

Plumes of smoke could be seen overhead in Aqaba in videos filmed by people in nearby

TRUMP'S THREAT

US President Donald Trump has warned Iran that the US will destroy one bridge or power plant each time Iran shoots at a ship in the Strait of Hormuz.

In his warning on social media, the US President returned to earlier threats to target civilian infrastructure in retaliation for Iranian attacks.

"From this point forward, any time the Islamic Republic of Iran shoots at a ship in the Strait of Hormuz, whether it be by Missile, Rocket, Drone, or any other device or weapon, the United States will bomb and destroy ONE BRIDGE OR POWER PLANT," Trump wrote on social media.

—AP

Eilat, Israel. Officials in Eilat described it as an Iranian missile attack that saw no fragments reach Israel.

Jordan has been repeatedly targeted by Iran for hosting US troops and aircraft.

Another recent attack on Aqaba saw Israeli officials warn that there could be a spillover of the Iranian attacks into its territory.

Loud explosion

The Iranian news agency Tasnim reported a US missile strike on the island of Larak in the Strait of Hormuz yesterday

afternoon, saying residents heard a loud explosion there. More than 50 people have been killed and nearly 600 wounded in US airstrikes on Iran since June 27, the Iranian Health Ministry said yesterday.

UAE condemns attacks

The UAE has condemned in the strongest terms the renewed hostile attacks by Iran targeting Bahrain, Kuwait, Jordan, and the Kurdistan Region of Iraq with missiles and drones.

It also slammed the statements made by the Houthi group against Saudi Arabia, including threats to impose a maritime blockade on the kingdom.

Open to diplomacy

At the Asean meeting in the Philippines, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said the United States remains open to diplomacy with Iran but will not accept Tehran controlling the Strait of Hormuz or restricting global shipping.

Meanwhile, the United States stepped up its naval blockade of Iran, redirecting eight commercial vessels and disabling another ship as its military campaign entered an 11th consecutive night.

Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said the Iran war has cost the United States \$37.5 billion so far, up from a previous estimate of nearly \$29 billion in mid-May.

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Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court with Prince Khalid Bin Salman, the Saudi Defence Minister.

DP World signs 50-year deal to develop Fujairah ports

Al Rugaylat and Dibba ports to expand container, vehicle and general cargo handling

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

DP World and the Fujairah Ports Authority have signed a 50-year concession agreement to develop two new multipurpose container ports in Fujairah, expanding the emirate's maritime capacity and establishing a new deep-water trade gateway on the Arabian Sea.

The agreement, covering Al Rugaylat Port and Dibba Port, was signed in the presence of Sheikh Mohammed Bin Hamad Bin Mohammed Al Sharqi, Crown Prince of Fujairah. Essa Kazim, Chairman of DP World Group, and Mousa Murad, Director of the Port of Fujairah, also attended the signing.

The project will establish a new deep-water commercial gateway in Fujairah capable of handling the latest generation of ultra-large container vessels. Al Rugaylat Port has been

designed to handle up to 2.5 million twenty-foot equivalent units annually, alongside 1.7 million tonnes of general cargo and 190,000 car equivalent units. Dibba Port will add annual capacity of up to 3.6 million tonnes of general cargo.

Connected network

Each port will be integrated with its own logistics zone, creating a connected network for cargo storage, distribution and onward transport. The terminals will also be linked to Jebel Ali Port and the Jebel Ali Free Zone through DP World's domestic logistics network.

The new terminals will be integrated with Jafza, extending DP World's end-to-end supply chain across the UAE. Positioned on the Gulf of Oman, Fujairah is expanding its ports and logistics infrastructure to attract investment, improve supply chains and create jobs. The development forms part of Fujairah's plan to strengthen its position as a maritime and logistics centre, with direct access to international shipping routes. Construction is expected to take between 24 and 30 months from the start of work.

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